

Apple best defines what a self sufficient ecosystem should look like and once you buy into it, it's difficult to get out of it. What started off as a company that sold personal computers, is now the world's most recognisable smartphone manufacturer, makes smartwatches, tablets, has one of the largest music streaming services, and now, its own e-wallet. So let's take a look at this addition to the Apple family of services dubbed the Apple Pay.

What is Apple Pay?

Apple Pay had been in works for quite some time before it was officially announced in 2014 alongside iPhone 6. Apple had been acquiring payment related start-ups, hiring people working in the field, filing patents and partnering with the giants in the payment industry including MasterCard and Visa for quite some time before that.

Apple Pay is a digital wallet and mobile payment system that lets users make secure transactions through their Apple devices. The system uses two factor authentication which is a combination of the Touch ID and a PIN/Passcode. It uses NFC to communicate with payment terminals. It can also be used to pay within various applications and websites.

Apple Pay on iOS 8.1 and can be used to make physical payments in stores using iPhone 6, 6S, 6 Plus, 6S Plus, SE, 7 and 7 Plus. The previous generation of devices (iPhone 5, 5C and 5S) didn't come equipped with NFC chips but can still be setup to use Apple Pay by pairing it with Apple Watch.

It also works with iPad Air 2, iPad Pro, iPad Mini 3 and 4 and Macbook Pro for in app and web based transactions.



Apple Pay faces competition from Samsung Pay and Android Pay